



THE EVERSPRING INN EVICTIONS: REGULATORY FAILURE & TENANT ABANDONMENT

In August 2020, during the height of COVID-19 and amid eviction moratoriums, Seattle's regulatory agencies allowed 25+ vulnerable tenants at the Everspring Inn to be forcibly removed from their homes—without due process, legal eviction notices, or relocation assistance. What followed was a coordinated effort to erase evidence of this failure from public record.

TIMELINE OF BETRAYAL

JULY 21, 2020

1

Ron Huebner files formal complaint with Department of Health requesting emergency intervention at Everspring Inn, citing safety violations and violent crime.

SDCI receives complaint but **takes no action** to protect tenants. Instead, routes to SPD.

2

AUGUST 1, 2020

Owner Ryan Kang begins illegal evictions. Utilities shut off. Armed guards patrol property. No court process. No relocation assistance.

Kang posts notices falsely claiming SPD ordered all tenants to vacate.

AUGUST 6, 2020

3

SPD signs nuisance abatement agreement with Kang - **after** evictions have already begun, providing retroactive cover for unlawful actions.

Agreement never authorized mass eviction but was weaponized to intimidate tenants.

4

AUGUST 18, 2020

Thirteen formal tenant complaints filed with SDCI. All marked "Just Cause Eviction"/"COVID19-X".

All complaints closed under "Voluntary Compliance" with **zero inspections, zero enforcement.**

SYSTEMATIC TENANT ABUSE

INTIMIDATION TACTICS

- Water shut off on August 8
- Armed security guards intimidated residents
- Cars towed from premises
- Doors and windows boarded while tenants still inside
- Threats of arrest for "trespassing" in their own homes

⊗ "Landlord Ryan Kang, came to my door with an armed-guard and asked if they could enter the room for a 'look around.' I was fearful and only allowed Landlord to enter into the doorway of my room." — Tenant complaint #007177-20CP



Residents reported being locked in the property on August 13 when security locked all gates, then threatened with criminal trespass if they didn't leave immediately.

SDCI'S ADMINISTRATIVE COVER-UP

1

COMPLAINT MANIPULATION

SDCI staff marked all complaints as "Admin Closed" or "Voluntary Compliance" on the same day they were filed, with no investigation.

Multiple staff members complicit: Stella Washington, Shantell McEachin, James Hammon all processed closures.

2

ADDRESS FALSIFICATION

To further distance itself from liability, SDCI created a separate property profile under "8217 Aurora Ave N" despite property being at 8201 Aurora.

Complaints from August 2020 were re-entered and re-dated as 2023 and 2024 to break connection to COVID moratorium.

3

FALSIFIED RECORDS

SDCI closed Ron Huebner's complaint claiming "Unable to investigate—no contact info" despite his letter containing clear contact information.

This wasn't a clerical error—it was deliberate obfuscation.

4

PUBLIC DECEPTION

SDCI spokesperson Bryan Stevens publicly claimed on August 25: "We're reviewing the matter" while internally all cases had already been closed.

No enforcement action was ever taken against the landlord for the unlawful evictions.

THE HUMAN COST



"I was in the hospital until last week because of a lung infection I believe was caused by black mold at the property. My sister was one of the two people who were shot at the motel."

—Nevaeh Love, seven months pregnant when evicted

Another tenant reported being forced onto the streets while caring for a terminally ill partner who "should not have left his room."

Many residents became homeless during a pandemic. No relocation assistance was ever offered. No enforcement from agencies meant to protect them.



DEPLORABLE CONDITIONS IGNORED FOR YEARS

A Notice of Violation was later issued in July 2021 by inspector Dustin Rasmussen, documenting **over 150 serious safety violations**, including:



TOXIC HAZARDS

Black mold throughout building, cracked bathtubs, deteriorated surfaces linked to respiratory infections



FIRE DANGERS

Blocked emergency exits, missing fire extinguishers, disabled fire doors, boarded windows preventing egress



BASIC SERVICES FAILURES

Inoperable plumbing, locked shared bathrooms, exposed electrical wiring, missing p-traps



INFESTATIONS

Rat infestations, rotting floors, unsecured structures, accumulation of garbage

STUNNING FINANCIAL CONTRADICTIONS

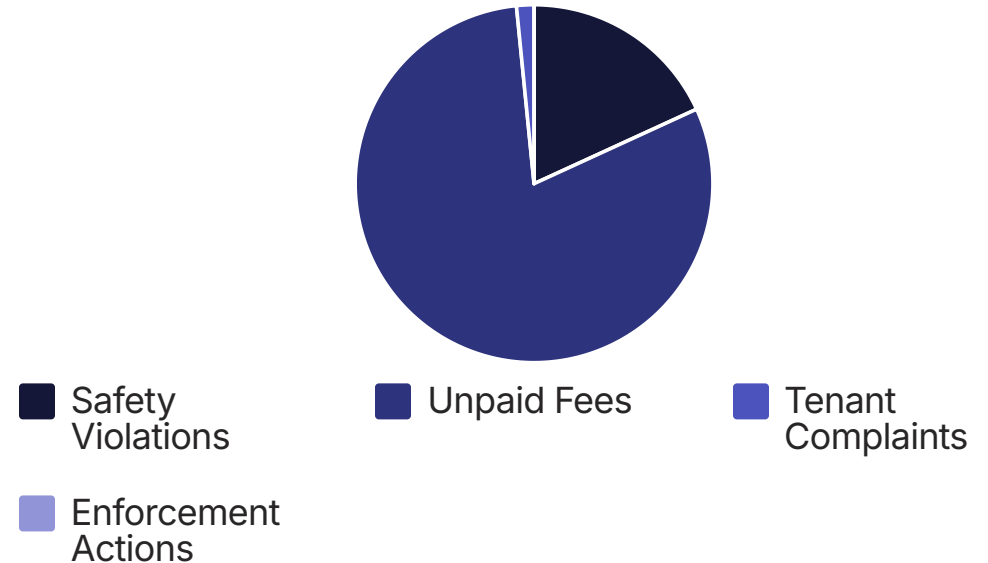


PUBLIC MONEY, PRIVATE PROFIT

Despite horrible conditions, Kang received over \$164,000 from the Rapid Rehousing program - the **LARGEST** single recipient of these funds in Seattle.

While collecting government money intended to stabilize housing, Kang allowed the building to deteriorate to uninhabitable conditions, then evicted the very tenants the funds were meant to help.

Records show Kang received permits to renovate after evictions but never paid multiple building inspection fees. Elevator operated without certification for years while SDCI inspectors visited but failed to report hazards.



THE REGULATORY COLLAPSE

SDCI ABANDONED TENANTS

- Closed all 13 complaints with no investigation
- Falsified records and contact information
- Failed to enforce eviction moratorium
- Refused to provide relocation assistance

SPD ENABLED LANDLORD

- Signed nuisance agreement after evictions began
- Created pretext for illegal displacement
- Failed to stop illegal actions by armed guards
- Did not enforce tenant protection laws

HUMAN SERVICES ABSENT

- Not notified by other agencies
- No coordination with outreach teams
- Minimal emergency housing options provided
- No accountability for RapidRehousing funds

"This wasn't a clerical error. It was a coordinated erasure. And the price was paid by 25 human beings who trusted the system to protect them."

WENDY SHARK'S DAMNING ADMISSION

"The city is monitoring the situation at the Everspring Inn, as well as the efforts to rehouse its residents. Whether or not the resident was technically a tenant is determined case by case analysis."

—Wendy Shark, SDCI Spokesperson, August 18, 2020

⊗ **THIS IS THE SMOKING GUN:** The city acknowledged it knew about the evictions while they were happening, yet took no enforcement action. The statement shows SDCI was actively looking for loopholes to avoid protecting tenants.

Despite this public admission that SDCI was "monitoring" the situation, all complaints were marked "closed" the same day. No inspectors were sent. No violations issued. No emergency orders. Just silence while vulnerable people were forced onto the streets during a pandemic.

DEMANDS FOR ACCOUNTABILITY AND REFORM



FULL INVESTIGATION

Complete investigation into both property profiles (8201 & 8217 Aurora Ave N) with public release of all complaint logs, case notes, and internal communications.



PERSONNEL REVIEW

Disciplinary review of all involved SDCI staff including Stella Washington, Shantell McEachin, Bryan Stevens, and others who facilitated this regulatory collapse.



STRUCTURAL REFORM

Permanent removal of SDCI's regulatory role over tenant protections and creation of the Seattle Tenant Landlord Compliance Authority (STLCA).



JUSTICE FOR TENANTS

Compensation for affected tenants and implementation of new protective measures to ensure this systematic failure cannot happen again.

The Everspring Inn case is not an isolated failure—it's proof of deep, systemic corruption in Seattle's tenant enforcement structure. At every step: the law was broken, complaints were hidden, tenants were abandoned, public funds were misused, and not a single city agency acted in good faith.